c.90,000 years ago
Burial rites
People begin burying their dead along with meaningful objects such as beads.

c.40,000 years ago
First music and art
Music is played on simple flutes, and figurines are carved from stone.

c.3200 BCE
Pirámide Mayor, Peru
Built by the Norte Chico civilization at Caral, the most ancient city in the Americas.

c.2589–2500 BCE
Pyramids of Giza, Egypt
Vast tombs are built for the Egyptian pharaohs Khufu, Khafre, and Menkaure.

1450 BCE
New Kingdom of Egypt
Egypt's empire stretches north to Syria and south to Nubia (modern Sudan).

c.700 BCE
Olmec civilization
Mexico's Olmec culture reaches its peak. It will influence the later Mayan and Aztec cultures.

490 BCE
First Persian Empire
Persia rules territory from the edge of India to Egypt and Greece, linking East with West.

323 BCE
Macedonian Empire
King Alexander the Great of Macedonia rules lands from Greece to the edge of India.

265 BCE
Mauryan Empire, Asia
Under Ashoka, the Mauryan Empire extends over almost all of the Indian subcontinent.

264–146 BCE
Punic Wars
Three wars erupt between Rome and Carthage, North Africa. Rome emerges victorious.

750
Umayyad Caliphate
The second of four great Islamic dynasties, with its capital in Damascus (Syria).

700
Tihuanaco, Peru/Bolivia
This strong state is centered on a bustling city beside Lake Titicaca in the Andes.

650
Huari Empire, Peru
The highly organized Huari, in Peru, conquer and control much of the Andean region.

555
Byzantine power
Byzantine rule extends over North Africa and the eastern part of the old Roman Empire.

c.300 CE
Mayan culture, Central America
Established by 1000 BCE, Mayan civilization is now at its height. It will last until 1697 CE.

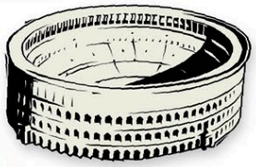
117 CE
Roman supremacy
Rome now controls much of Europe, north Africa, and the Middle East.

100 CE
Pyramid of the Sun, Mexico
One of two huge stepped pyramids is built in the city of Teotihuacán.

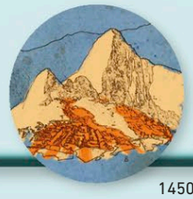
80 CE
Colosseum, Rome
Opening of the stadium in Rome where gladiators fought to the death.

87 BCE
Han Dynasty, China
A time of prosperity in China and an expansion of territories ruled by China.

214 BCE
Great Wall of China
Construction begins of this vast defensive wall along China's northern border.



Colosseum, Rome



1450
Machu Picchu, Peru
A secret hilltop city of the Incas, who will dominate northern South America.

1453
Fall of Constantinople
The capital of the Byzantine Empire falls to invading Muslim Ottoman forces.

1500
Ming Dynasty, China
After throwing out the Mongols, China restores its culture and expands its borders.

1500
Songhai power, Africa
The Songhai control the Niger Valley, west to Senegal and east to Agades (modern Niger).

1519
Aztec rule, Mexico
The Aztecs now rule more than 25 million people. In 1521, they are conquered by the Spanish.

1532
Battle of Cajamarca, Peru
Spanish invaders defeat the Inca forces of Atahualpa, leading to 300 years of Spanish rule.

1642–51
English Civil War
Parliamentarians defeat Royalists, leading to the execution of King Charles I.

1683
Battle of Vienna
Ottoman expansion finally halts with a defeat by the Holy Roman Empire.

1690
Mughal Empire, India
Under Aurangzeb, the Islamic Mughal Empire of India is at its most powerful.

1922
Height of British Empire
Britain's empire now covers more than 20 percent of the world's land area.

1917
Russian Revolution
Revolt against rule by Tsar Nicholas II; Russia becomes Communist.

1914–18
World War I
Britain, France, the US, and other allies battle Germany, Austria-Hungary, and Turkey.

1912
Sinking of the *Titanic*
More than 1,500 people die when this luxury liner hits an iceberg and sinks.

1880–1902
Boer Wars, Africa
Two wars are fought between Dutch Boer settlers in South Africa and Britain.

1861–65
American Civil War
War between the southern Confederate states and the Union states of the north.

1819–30
South American independence
Independence from Spain for Colombia, Peru, Bolivia, Ecuador, and Venezuela.

1799–1815
Napoleonic era
France, led by Napoleon Bonaparte, is the dominant military power in Europe.

1789–99
French Revolution
Overthrow of the French monarchy in a bloody revolution. France becomes a republic.

1775–83
American Revolutionary War
With the help of France and other countries, the US wins independence from Britain.

1980
Very Large Array
In New Mexico, this giant radio astronomy observatory is completed.



1994
End of Apartheid
South Africa's official segregation policy, Apartheid, ends and equality is reached for Black South Africans.

1989–1991
End of Communist bloc
Communist regimes in many countries of eastern Europe are overthrown.

Sydney Opera House
Opened in 1973, this arts venue in Sydney, Australia, was designed by Danish architect Jørn Utzon.

ONLY VIRUS TO BE ERADICATED THROUGH VACCINATION.